

考研英语阅读 Text 2

一、文章主旨

英文主旨

The text draws a parallel between the past smoking controversy and the current global warming issue, arguing that just as we delayed action on smoking leading to millions of deaths, we must not repeat the mistake with global warming; instead, we should take immediate, proactive measures (rather than endless research) to address the man-made climate crisis, with Congress and the government taking legislative and policy action.

中文主旨

文章将过去的吸烟争议与当下的全球变暖问题做类比，指出正如我们当年在吸烟问题上拖延行动导致数百万人死亡，如今绝不能在全球变暖问题上重蹈覆辙；我们必须立即采取主动措施（而非无休止的研究）来应对人为造成的气候危机，国会和政府应出台立法与政策行动。

二、逐句精读（翻译+核心词汇+长难句分析）

第一段

1. **原文**：Do you remember all those years when scientists argued that smoking would kill us but the doubters insisted that we didn't know for sure?

翻译：你还记得那些年吗？科学家们声称吸烟会致命，但怀疑论者却坚称我们对此尚无定论。

常考单词/短语：

- **argue**：v. 主张，声称；争论
- **doubter**：n. 怀疑者，持怀疑态度的人
- **insist**：v. 坚持认为；坚决要求
- **for sure**：确切地，毫无疑问地

长难句分析：复合句，主句为 Do you remember all those years, **when** 引导定语从句修饰 years；定语从句由 **but** 连接两个并列句：**scientists argued that...**（**that** 引导宾语从句）和 **the doubters insisted that...**（**that** 引导宾语从句）。

2. **原文**：That the evidence was inconclusive, the science uncertain?

翻译：认为证据不确凿、科学尚无定论？

补充说明：省略结构，完整为 **That the evidence was inconclusive, (that) the science (was) uncertain?**，承接上句 **insisted that...**

常考单词/短语：

- **evidence**：n. 证据，证明
- **inconclusive**：adj. 无定论的，不确定的
- **uncertain**：adj. 不确定的，不明确的

3. **原文**：That the antismoking lobby was out to destroy our way of life and the government should stay out of the way?

翻译：认为反吸烟游说团体一心要毁掉我们的生活方式，而政府应当袖手旁观？

常考单词/短语：

- **antismoking**：adj. 反对吸烟的
- **lobby**：n. 游说团体；大厅 v. 游说

- **be out to do sth.**: 一心要做某事, 力图做某事
- **way of life**: 生活方式
- **stay out of the way**: 不干涉, 袖手旁观, 置身事外

4. **原文**: Lots of Americans bought that nonsense, and over three decades, some 10 million smokers went to early graves.

翻译: 许多美国人听信了这些胡言乱语, 三十多年间, 约1000万烟民早早离世。

常考单词/短语:

- **buy**: v. (口语) 相信, 接受 (非“购买”)
- **nonsense**: n. 胡说, 胡言乱语, 荒谬的话
- **over three decades**: 三十多年间
- **some**: adj. 大约, 大概 (=about)
- **go to early graves**: 英年早逝, 过早离世

第二段

1. **原文**: There are upsetting parallels today, as scientists in one wave after another try to awaken us to the growing threat of global warming.

翻译: 如今出现了令人不安的相似情形: 科学家们一波接一波地试图让我们意识到全球变暖日益加剧的威胁。

常考单词/短语:

- **upsetting**: adj. 令人不安的, 令人担忧的
- **parallel**: n. 相似之处, 类比 adj. 平行的
- **in one wave after another**: 一波接一波地, 接连不断地
- **awaken sb. to sth.**: 使某人意识到某事, 唤醒某人注意某事
- **growing threat**: 日益加剧的威胁
- **global warming**: 全球变暖

长难句分析: 主句为 **There are upsetting parallels today**, **as** 引导时间/原因状语从句; 从句中 **scientists** 为主语, **try to awaken** 为谓语, **us** 为宾语, **to the growing threat...** 为宾语补足语。

2. **原文**: The latest was a panel from the National Academy of Sciences, enlisted by the White House, to tell us that the Earth's atmosphere is definitely warming and that the problem is largely man-made.

翻译: 最新的一次是由白宫召集的美国国家科学院专家小组, 他们告知我们: 地球大气层确实在变暖, 且这一问题在很大程度上是人为造成的。

常考单词/短语:

- **latest**: adj. 最新的, 最近的 n. 最新情况
- **panel**: n. 专家小组, 专门小组; 面板
- **National Academy of Sciences**: 美国国家科学院
- **enlist**: v. 征募, 召集; 争取 (支持)
- **definitely**: adv. 肯定地, 确实地
- **atmosphere**: n. 大气, 大气层; 氛围
- **largely**: adv. 很大程度上, 主要地
- **man-made**: adj. 人造的, 人为的

长难句分析: 主句为 **The latest was a panel...**; **from the National Academy of Sciences** 为后置定语修饰 **panel**; **enlisted by the white House** 为过去分词短语作后置定语 (表被动“被白宫召集”); **to tell us that...** 为不定式作目的状语; **tell** 后接两个 **that** 引导的并列宾语从句。

3. **原文**: The clear message is that we should get moving to protect ourselves.

翻译: 明确的信息是: 我们应当立即行动起来保护自己。

常考单词/短语:

- **message**: n. 信息, 要旨
- **get moving**: 行动起来, 赶紧行动
- **protect**: v. 保护, 防护

4. **原文**: The president of the National Academy, Bruce Alberts, added this key point in the preface to the panel's report:

翻译: 美国国家科学院院长布鲁斯·艾伯茨在专家小组报告的序言中补充了这一关键观点:

常考单词/短语:

- **president**: n. 院长; 总统; 主席
- **add**: v. 补充说, 补充
- **key point**: 关键点, 核心观点
- **preface**: n. 序言, 前言
- **report**: n. 报告

5. **原文**: "Science never has all the answers.

翻译: "科学永远无法给出所有答案。

常考单词/短语:

- **never**: adv. 从不, 绝不
- **answer**: n. 答案, 解答

6. **原文**: But science does provide us with the best available guide to the future, and it is critical that our nation and the world base important policies on the best judgments that science can provide concerning the future consequences of present actions."

翻译: 但科学确实能为我们提供面向未来的最可靠指引; 至关重要的是, 我国乃至全世界都应基于科学所能给出的最佳判断, 来制定关乎当前行为未来影响的重要政策。

常考单词/短语:

- **provide sb. with sth.**: 为某人提供某物
- **available**: adj. 可获得的, 可用的
- **guide**: n. 指引, 指导 v. 引导
- **critical**: adj. 至关重要的; 批判的
- **base...on...**: 以.....为基础, 基于.....
- **judgment**: n. 判断, 看法
- **concerning**: prep. 关于, 涉及
- **consequence**: n. 结果, 后果
- **present**: adj. 当前的, 现在的

长难句分析: and 连接的并列句:

- 前半句: **But science does provide us with the best available guide to the future** (does 表强调, 谓语 provide, 结构 provide sb. with sth.)
 - 后半句: **it is critical that...** (it 为形式主语, 真正主语为 that 引导的主语从句); 主语从句中 **our nation and the world** 为主语, **base** 为谓语, **important policies** 为宾语, **on the best judgments** 为状语; **judgments** 后接 that 引导的定语从句; **concerning the future consequences...** 为现在分词短语作后置定语修饰 **judgments**。
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第三段

1. **原文**: Just as on smoking, voices now come from many quarters insisting that the science about global warming is incomplete, that it's OK to keep pouring fumes into the air until we know for sure.

翻译: 就像当年在吸烟问题上一样, 如今来自各方的声音坚称: 全球变暖的科学依据尚不充分, 在我们完全确定之前, 继续向空气中排放废气是无妨的。

常考单词/短语:

- just as: 正如, 就像
- quarter: n. (常用复数) 方面, 群体, 来源
- insist: v. 坚持认为
- incomplete: adj. 不完整的, 不充分的
- pour fumes into the air: 向空气中排放废气
- until: conj. 直到.....为止

长难句分析: 主句为 voices now come from many quarters; Just as on smoking 为比较状语; insisting that... 为现在分词短语作后置定语修饰 voices; insist 后接两个 that 引导的并列宾语从句; 第二个宾语从句中 it 为形式主语, 真正主语为 to keep pouring..., until 引导时间状语从句。

2. **原文**: This is a dangerous game: by the time 100 percent of the evidence is in, it may be too late.

翻译: 这是一场危险的博弈: 等到100%的证据都确凿无疑时, 可能为时已晚。

常考单词/短语:

- dangerous: adj. 危险的
- by the time: 到.....的时候 (引导时间状语从句)
- evidence is in: 证据确凿, 证据齐全
- too late: 太晚, 为时已晚

3. **原文**: With the risks obvious and growing, a prudent people would take out an insurance policy now.

翻译: 既然风险显而易见且不断加剧, 一个审慎的民族如今就应当未雨绸缪 (购买一份“保险”)。

常考单词/短语:

- obvious: adj. 明显的, 显而易见的
- growing: adj. 不断增长的, 日益加剧的
- prudent: adj. 审慎的, 谨慎的
- take out an insurance policy: 购买保险 (比喻义: 采取预防措施、未雨绸缪)

长难句分析: with the risks obvious and growing 为 with 复合结构 (with + 宾语 + 宾补), 作原因状语; 主句为 a prudent people would take out....。

第四段

1. **原文**: Fortunately, the White House is starting to pay attention.

翻译: 幸运的是, 白宫已开始予以关注。

常考单词/短语:

- fortunately: adv. 幸运的是, 所幸
- start to do sth.: 开始做某事
- pay attention: 注意, 关注

2. **原文**: But it's obvious that a majority of the president's advisers still don't take global warming seriously.

翻译: 但显而易见的是, 总统的大多数顾问仍未认真对待全球变暖问题。

常考单词/短语:

- **it is obvious that...**: 显而易见的是..... (**it** 作形式主语)
- **a majority of**: 大多数的
- **adviser**: n. 顾问, 谋士
- **take...seriously**: 认真对待.....

长难句分析: **it** 为形式主语, 真正主语为 **that** 引导的主语从句。

3. **原文**: Instead of a plan of action, they continue to press for more research — a classic case of “paralysis by analysis”.

翻译: 他们非但没有制定行动计划, 反而不断要求开展更多研究——这是典型的“分析导致瘫痪”(空谈研究、拖延行动)。

常考单词/短语:

- **instead of**: 而不是, 代替
- **plan of action**: 行动计划
- **continue to do sth.**: 继续做某事
- **press for**: 迫切要求, 敦促
- **paralysis by analysis**: 分析瘫痪 (过度分析导致无法行动)
- **classic**: adj. 典型的, 经典的

长难句分析: 破折号后为同位语, 解释说明前文内容; **Instead of...** 为介词短语作状语。

第五段

1. **原文**: To serve as responsible stewards of the planet, we must press forward on deeper atmospheric and oceanic research.

翻译: 要成为这个星球负责任的管理者, 我们必须推进更深层次的大气与海洋研究。

常考单词/短语:

- **serve as**: 充当, 担任, 作为
- **responsible**: adj. 负责的
- **steward**: n. 管理者, 管家; 乘务员
- **planet**: n. 行星, 地球
- **press forward on**: 推进, 继续推进
- **atmospheric**: adj. 大气的, 大气层的
- **oceanic**: adj. 海洋的

长难句分析: **To serve as...** 为不定式作目的状语; 主句为 **we must press forward on...**。

2. **原文**: But research alone is inadequate.

翻译: 但仅靠研究是不够的。

常考单词/短语:

- **alone**: adv. 仅仅, 只 (adj. 独自的)
- **inadequate**: adj. 不足的, 不够的; 不适当的

3. **原文**: If the Administration won't take the legislative initiative, Congress should help to begin fashioning conservation measures.

翻译: 如果政府不主动采取立法行动, 国会就应当助力制定环保措施。

常考单词/短语:

- **administration**: n. 政府, 行政部门 (指美国政府)
- **take the initiative**: 采取主动, 带头
- **legislative**: adj. 立法的
- **fashion**: v. 制定, 塑造; n. 时尚
- **conservation**: n. 环保, 保护; 保存

- **measure**: n. 措施, 方法

长难句分析: **if** 引导条件状语从句, 主句为 **Congress should help to...**。

4. **原文:** A bill by Democratic Senator Robert Byrd of West Virginia, which would offer financial incentives for private industry, is a promising start.

翻译: 西弗吉尼亚州民主党参议员罗伯特·伯德提出的一项法案 (将为私营企业提供经济激励) 是一个良好的开端。

常考单词/短语:

- **bill**: n. 法案, 议案; 账单
- **Democratic**: adj. 民主党的
- **senator**: n. 参议员
- **offer**: v. 提供, 给予
- **financial incentive**: 经济激励, 财政激励
- **private industry**: 私营企业
- **promising**: adj. 有希望的, 良好的, 有前途的
- **start**: n. 开端, 起点

长难句分析: 主句为 **A bill...is a promising start**; **by...** 为后置定语修饰 **bill**; **which** 引导非限制性定语从句, 补充说明法案内容。

5. **原文:** Many see that the country is getting ready to build lots of new power plants to meet our energy needs.

翻译: 许多人都明白, 我国正准备修建大量新发电厂以满足能源需求。

常考单词/短语:

- **get ready to do sth.**: 准备好做某事
- **power plant**: 发电厂, 电站
- **meet one's needs**: 满足某人的需求
- **energy**: n. 能源, 能量

长难句分析: **that** 引导宾语从句, 从句中 **to meet...** 为不定式作目的状语。

6. **原文:** If we are ever going to protect the atmosphere, it is crucial that those new plants be environmentally sound.

翻译: 如果我们始终想要保护大气, 那么至关重要的一点是, 这些新发电厂必须对环境无害。

常考单词/短语:

- **ever**: adv. 始终, 终究
- **crucial**: adj. 至关重要的, 关键性的
- **environmentally sound**: 对环境无害的, 环保的

长难句分析: **If** 引导条件状语从句; 主句中 **it** 为形式主语, **that** 引导主语从句, 从句使用虚拟语气 (**should**) **be**, 表建议、要求。

7. **原文:** That is the only way to make sure that, as we grow smarter, we don't do worse by the planet.

翻译: 唯有如此, 才能确保我们在变得更明智的同时, 不会对地球造成更严重的破坏。

常考单词/短语:

- **make sure**: 确保, 保证
- **grow smarter**: 变得更明智
- **do worse by the planet**: 对地球造成更严重的损害

长难句分析: 主句 **That is the only way**, **to make sure that...** 为不定式作后置定语; **make sure** 后接宾语从句, 从句中 **as** 引导时间状语从句。

三、完整文章原文

Do you remember all those years when scientists argued that smoking would kill us but the doubters insisted that we didn't know for sure? That the evidence was inconclusive, the science uncertain? That the antismoking lobby was out to destroy our way of life and the government should stay out of the way? Lots of Americans bought that nonsense, and over three decades, some 10 million smokers went to early graves.

There are upsetting parallels today, as scientists in one wave after another try to awaken us to the growing threat of global warming. The latest was a panel from the National Academy of Sciences, enlisted by the White House, to tell us that the Earth's atmosphere is definitely warming and that the problem is largely man-made. The clear message is that we should get moving to protect ourselves. The president of the National Academy, Bruce Alberts, added this key point in the preface to the panel's report: "Science never has all the answers. But science does provide us with the best available guide to the future, and it is critical that our nation and the world base important policies on the best judgments that science can provide concerning the future consequences of present actions."

Just as on smoking, voices now come from many quarters insisting that the science about global warming is incomplete, that it's OK to keep pouring fumes into the air until we know for sure. This is a dangerous game: by the time 100 percent of the evidence is in, it may be too late. With the risks obvious and growing, a prudent people would take out an insurance policy now.

Fortunately, the White House is starting to pay attention. But it's obvious that a majority of the president's advisers still don't take global warming seriously. Instead of a plan of action, they continue to press for more research — a classic case of "paralysis by analysis".

To serve as responsible stewards of the planet, we must press forward on deeper atmospheric and oceanic research. But research alone is inadequate. If the Administration won't take the legislative initiative, Congress should help to begin fashioning conservation measures. A bill by Democratic Senator Robert Byrd of West Virginia, which would offer financial incentives for private industry, is a promising start. Many see that the country is getting ready to build lots of new power plants to meet our energy needs. If we are ever going to protect the atmosphere, it is crucial that those new plants be environmentally sound. That is the only way to make sure that, as we grow smarter, we don't do worse by the planet.

四、完整文章翻译

你还记得那些年吗？科学家们声称吸烟会致命，但怀疑论者却坚称我们对此尚无定论。他们认为证据并不确凿，科学研究也尚无定论；认为反吸烟游说团体一心要毁掉我们的生活方式，而政府应当袖手旁观。许多美国人听信了这些胡言乱语，三十多年间，约一千万烟民早早离开了人世。

如今出现了令人不安的相似情形：科学家们一波接一波地试图让我们意识到全球变暖日益加剧的威胁。最近一次发声的是由白宫召集的美国国家科学院专家小组，他们告知我们，地球大气层确实在变暖，且这一问题在很大程度上是人为造成的。这条信息明确地告诉我们，应当立即行动起来保护自己。美国国家科学院院长布鲁斯·艾伯茨在该专家小组报告的序言中补充了这一关键观点：“科学永远无法解答所有问题。但科学确实能为我们提供面向未来最可靠的指引；至关重要的是，我们国家乃至全世界都应基于科学所能提供的最佳判断，来制定关乎当下行为未来后果的重要政策。”

就像当年在吸烟问题上一样，如今来自各方的声音都坚称，关于全球变暖的科学研究尚不完整，在我们完全确定之前，继续向空气中排放废气也无妨。这是一场危险的博弈：等到百分之百的证据都确凿无疑时，可能一切都为时已晚。风险已然显而易见且不断加剧，一个审慎的民族如今就应当未雨绸缪。

幸运的是，白宫已经开始关注这一问题。但显而易见的是，总统的大多数顾问仍然没有认真对待全球变暖问题。他们没有制定行动计划，反而不断敦促开展更多研究——这是典型的“分析导致瘫痪”。

要成为这个星球负责任的守护者，我们必须推进更深入的大气与海洋研究。但仅靠研究是远远不够的。如果政府不主动采取立法举措，国会就应当协助制定环保措施。西弗吉尼亚州民主党参议员罗伯特·伯德提出的一项法案，将为私营企业提供经济激励，这是一个充满希望的开端。许多人都意识到，国家正准备修建大量新的发电厂以满足我们的能源需求。如果我们始终想要保护大气层，那么至关重要是，这些新发电厂必须做到对环境无害。唯有如此，才能确保我们在变得更加明智的同时，不会对地球造成更严重的破坏。